settlement to settlement, eventually ending up in Yitzhar and studying at Od Yosef Chai, the extremist *yeshiva* shuttered by the army in 2014 for its connection to the attacks on soldiers posted there. By the time of the Douma arson, he was the top suspect on the Shin Bet's list of Jewish extremists.

Ettinger does not give interviews, but he used to blog regularly on *HaKol HaYehudi*, "The Jewish Voice", a portal that mixes news with far-right political and religious commentary. He also wrote a private document that the Shin Bet describes as his "plan for rebellion", a plot to topple the state.

At first glance it seems outlandish, the ramblings of an angry, messianic youth. And yet, on reflection, there was a logic to it. Communists once spoke of "heightening the contradictions", trying to intensify the problems in capitalist society to produce a revolution—making things worse before they get better. Ettinger simply adapted that argument to a Jewish state. "The goal is disturbing the foundations of the state until the point where the Jews are forced to decide whether they want to take part in the revolution or in suppressing the revolt, because it will not be possible to ignore it or continue to sit and do nothing," he wrote.

Will Ettinger overthrow the state and replace it with a Jewish kingdom? No. His movement is small, and the state is powerful. But his writings, extreme as they are, touch on a valid point: there are indeed contradictions between being Jewish and democratic. From an army that increasingly worries about dissent in the ranks, to a cabinet that appeases the sensitivities of its most religious members, these inconsistencies are at the core of Israel's contemporary problems.

"The idea of the revolt is very simple," Ettinger added. "The state of Israel has many 'weak points', issues on which it moves on tiptoe so as not to spark riots. What we will do is simply to 'spark' all of these explosive barrels, all of these contradictions between Judaism and democracy."

## *"It's difficult to stop"*

A pair of bodies on the pavement, covered in blood-spattered white sheets. Dozens of police officers sweeping through Jabal al-Mukaber, a rough neighborhood in East Jerusalem, searching cars and clashing with local youth. An emergency cabinet meeting to discuss home demolitions and closing the Palestinian parts of Israel's "eternally reunited" capital to traffic.